Contractor Leads SEO work report

6 November 2026 · https://www.contractorleads.us · Branch claude/quirky-thompson-65u09b, commit 41fe405 (goes live when merged to master)

11 new pages (8 list pages, 3 guides)	**2** public pages unblocked in robots.txt	**3.9s → 0.9s** homepage LCP, throttled mobile	**471** sitemap pages checked, 0 problems

1. How today's work was chosen

- **Search Console:** not connected to the Contractor Leads project in OpenSEO, so first-party ranking, click and indexing data was not available today.
- **Keyword tool credits:** the OpenSEO organisation had no credits left, so search volumes and difficulty scores were not measured. Keywords were chosen from live search results and competitor pages instead, and are labelled as unmeasured.
- **Audit:** every sitemap URL was crawled on a local production build (titles, descriptions, canonicals, H1/H2, alt text, broken links, orphans, duplicates, thin content), structured data was validated, and mobile layout and page speed were measured in a throttled mobile browser.

2. Competitor gap and targeted keywords

Live results for “HVAC contractor email list”, “roofing company email list” and similar searches are led by list sellers and data tools with one page per trade: Prospeo (prospeo.io/e/hvac-email-list), Orbital (withorbital.com), ByteScraper and BizKonnect. Contractor Leads had no page answering these searches. Today's new section answers them honestly: Contractor Leads builds a fresh, verified list instead of selling a stale one.

Page	Primary keyword	Secondary keywords
/email-lists	contractor email list	contractors email list, construction contractor email list, contractor mailing list
/email-lists/roofing	roofing contractor email list	roofing company email list, roofers email list, list of roofing companies
/email-lists/hvac	HVAC contractor email list	hvac email list, hvac contractors list, list of hvac companies
/email-lists/plumbing	plumbing contractor email list	plumber email list, list of plumbing companies
/email-lists/electrical	electrical contractor email list	electrician email list, list of electrical contractors
/email-lists/solar	solar installer email list	solar company email list, solar contractors list
/email-lists/general-contractors	general contractor email list	construction company email list, list of general contractors
/email-lists/remodeling	remodeling contractor email list	remodeler email list, home improvement contractor email list
/blog/contractor-license-lookup-owner-name	contractor license lookup	find owner of contracting business, contractor license search by name

Page	Primary keyword	Secondary keywords
/blog/buy-vs-build-contractor-email-list	buy contractor email list	construction email list, are bought email lists worth it
/blog/can-spam-cold-email-contractors	CAN-SPAM cold email	is cold email legal, cold email compliance, CAN-SPAM opt out 10 days
/help/gmail-app-password-setup	gmail app password smtp	gmail smtp settings, gmail app password not working

3. New pages and published content

- **Contractor email lists hub + 7 trade pages.** Each trade page has its own segments table, who buys from that trade, licensing context, best timing, six state links and trade-specific FAQs (1,100+ words each), plus Service, FAQPage and BreadcrumbList structured data. No record counts or accuracy rates are claimed.
- **Guide: contractor license lookup.** Licensing bodies in 10 large states and a five-source workflow to confirm the owner of a contracting business.
- **Guide: buy vs build a contractor email list.** Side-by-side comparison, the cost of stale data, and a checklist for any list vendor.
- **Guide: CAN-SPAM and cold email to contractors.** The seven FTC requirements, mailbox-provider rules (SPF/DKIM/DMARC, 0.3% spam threshold), a compliant footer and a pre-send checklist.
- **Expanded help article:** Gmail app password setup, now with SMTP settings, Google Workspace notes, Google's daily sending limits and fixes for common errors.
- **Case studies:** not published. There is no real customer data to base them on, and invented results would mislead buyers. See section 7.

4. Technical fixes

Issue found	Fix	Result
robots.txt prefix rules blocked public pages: “/home” blocked /homeowner-leads, “/sms” blocked /sms-marketing-for-contractors, and “/email” would have blocked the new /email-lists pages	Every private section is now blocked only as an exact path and its children (/home$ and /home/); missing app routes added	All public pages crawlable; app pages still blocked
Homepage loaded 3.3 MB of images: a 3 MB animated background below the fold, loaded eagerly	Re-encoded (same playback, 576 KB) and lazy-loaded	Homepage first-load images 3,324 KB → 109 KB
Hero image (the LCP element) was a 190 KB JPEG rendered at opacity 0 until JavaScript ran	WebP (58 KB), visible in the server HTML, high fetch priority	Throttled mobile LCP 3,880 ms → about 900 ms
Site-wide image without alt text (Meta pixel fallback); GTM iframe without a title	alt="" and a title added	0 images without alt text
Trade hub H1s and titles: “Home Improvement contractor leads”, “Garage Doors Contractor Leads”, “Windows & Doors contractor leads”	Proper search phrases and custom copy for 6 trades; cleaning and pool service renamed to how people search	Consistent titles under 60 characters
“contractor email list” targeted by the email finder page	Moved to the new hub to avoid two pages competing	One page per keyword

5. Internal linking

- Footer link to /email-lists on every page (468 pages link to the hub).
- Each trade email list page is linked from its trade hub, all 50 of that trade's state pages, the hub and the footer section (52-53 linking pages each).
- New auto-links in guides and landing pages for CAN-SPAM, license lookups, bought lists and contractor email lists (the three guides now have 10-17 linking pages each).

6. Verification and indexing status

Check	Result
Production build, type check, lint	Pass (lint: 0 errors; existing <img> warnings only)
Crawl of all 471 sitemap URLs	0 broken links, 0 orphans, 0 duplicate titles or descriptions, all titles < 60 and descriptions < 155 characters
Structured data (984 JSON-LD blocks)	0 errors; FAQPage 435, BreadcrumbList 470, Service 29, BlogPosting 42
Content standard (keyword placement, 40-60 word quick answer, FAQs 40-70 words)	All 18 landing pages pass (10 existing + 8 new)
Mobile (Pixel 7 viewport)	No horizontal overflow, one H1 per page, no tiny tap targets
Sitemap	11 new URLs in sitemap-core and sitemap-blog with lastmod 2026-11-06
Google Search Console	Not connected in OpenSEO: URL inspection and indexing requests not possible from here
IndexNow (Bing, Yandex)	Held until the branch is live: submitting URLs that still return 404 would waste the crawl

7. Needs your decision

Fake purchase pop-ups on the homepage

The marketing site shows pop-ups such as “Noah in Chicago, IL purchased Starter plan”. They come from a hard-coded list of invented purchases (the component calls them FakePurchase). Fake social proof can breach FTC rules on deceptive practices, and it undermines trust if noticed. Recommended: remove it, or feed it from real, anonymised purchases. Not changed today because it is a business decision.

8. Next steps and further opportunities

- **Merge the branch**, then submit the 11 new URLs and the robots.txt change to IndexNow and request indexing in Search Console.
- **Connect Search Console in OpenSEO** (app.openseo.so, project Contractor Leads, Search performance) and add OpenSEO credits, so the next round can target queries already ranking in positions 5-20 and measure volumes.
- **Real case studies:** two or three customer stories with permission (agency, trade, area, leads found, replies, deals). These are the strongest trust and conversion content available.
- **Extend email list pages** to landscaping, painting, pest control and other trades once the first seven show impressions.
- **Thin pages:** 7 help articles under 500 words, plus /enterprise/book; expand the ones with search demand.

- **Comparison content:** pages against Orbital and BizKonnect, now that they are visible competitors for list searches.

Rankings cannot be guaranteed; Google decides them, and new pages usually take a few weeks to move. This report covers technical correctness, content and linking, which were verified before delivery.